THE KEEFE TEAM · JLA REALTY · ALEDO, TEXAS

Selling Your Home in North Texas

Selling is mostly a sequence of decisions: what to fix, what to ask, when to list, which offer to take. This is how we walk sellers through each one here in North Texas, where a house in Fort Worth and a place on acreage outside Weatherford sell very differently.



Lisa Keefe, Broker Associate, SRES® · Jennifer Keefe, REALTOR® · 817-807-3367 · keefeteamrealty.com

1. Start with the number that matters: what you'll walk away with

Before we talk list price, we build your net sheet: the likely sale price minus your mortgage payoff, closing costs, title fees, any repairs or credits, and commissions. That's the number that decides whether and when you sell, and it's the one most sellers never see until closing.

If you're also buying, we run both sides together so you know what you'll have for the next place.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Decide based on your net, not the list price.**

2. Price it right the first time

The first two weeks on the market are when the most buyers see your home. Overprice it, and those buyers pass, the listing goes stale, and you end up chasing the market down with price cuts. Price it right and you get showings, competition, and often more than you'd have gotten by aiming high.

We price from real closed sales in your specific area and property type, not an online estimate. Acreage, barns, shops, wells, ag exemptions and school district all move the number, and the online tools get those wrong.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **A home priced right on day one almost always nets more than one priced high and reduced later.**

3. Prepare the house, but don't over-improve

Jennifer has renovated and flipped more than 20 houses, so we know which dollars come back and which don't. Paint, lighting, deep cleaning, landscaping and fixing the obvious almost always pay. A full kitchen remodel before selling almost never does.

On acreage, buyers judge the land as much as the house: mow and clear, fix fence lines, make sure gates swing, and clean out the barn. If the well, septic or roof has a known issue, it's usually better to address it or price for it than to let a buyer's inspector find it.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Ask us for a walk-through before you spend anything. We'll tell you what to do and what to skip.**

4. The paperwork you'll need

Texas requires a Seller's Disclosure Notice, where you state what you know about the property's condition. Honesty here protects you later. You'll also want your survey (or we'll order one), the T-47 affidavit that goes with it, any HOA documents, warranties, and records on the roof, HVAC, well and septic.

If the home is in a trust, inherited, or someone will sign under a power of attorney, tell us early so the title company can confirm who's able to sign.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Gather the papers before listing. Missing documents are the most common reason a closing slips.**

5. Marketing: photos first, then everywhere

Buyers decide whether to visit from the photos, so we start with professional photography and, for acreage, drone shots that show the whole property. Your listing goes to the MLS, which feeds Zillow, Realtor.com, HAR and every brokerage site in Texas, plus our own channels, social media and the agents we work with across Parker, Tarrant and the DFW counties.

We write the listing for the buyer who's actually looking for your property. A horse place gets described for horse people: stalls, turnout, arena footing, hay storage, trailer access. A family home in Aledo gets the school district and the commute.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **The listing should answer the questions a serious buyer would ask on the phone.**

6. Showings and offers

We'll set showing rules that work for your life and your animals. When offers come in, we look past the price to the terms: financing strength, option period, closing date, requested repairs, and whether the buyer's lender and agent are ones that close. A slightly lower cash offer with a short option period can be worth more than a higher one with a shaky loan.

If there are multiple offers, we'll run them side by side and tell you plainly which one we'd take and why.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **The strongest offer is the one most likely to close on your terms, not always the highest number.**

7. From contract to closing

The buyer inspects during the option period and may ask for repairs or a credit. We negotiate that for you. Then the buyer's lender orders an appraisal; if it comes in low, we handle that conversation too. The title company clears title, you sign a few days before or on closing day, and funds hit your account once the buyer's loan funds.

Our job in this stretch is to keep everyone on the timeline and to tell you about any bump before it becomes a problem.

> **Keefe Team tip:** **Keep the house in showing condition until the buyer's final walk-through.**

8. Moving out

Our 16-foot enclosed trailer is yours for up to 7 days at no charge. Reserve your dates with us before closing. Leave the house broom-clean, leave the keys, garage openers and manuals, and cancel utilities for the day after closing, not before.

If you're downsizing, our Seniors & Downsizing guide walks through the sorting and the handoff. If you're buying your next place with us, we line the two closings up so you're not stuck in between.

Thinking about selling but not sure when?

We'll give you a free, no-pressure opinion of what your home would sell for today and what you'd net. No obligation. Many of our clients start that conversation a year before they list.

Questions we hear most

Should I sell before I buy, or buy first?

It depends on your finances and the market. Many North Texas sellers list with a contingency or use a short leaseback to stay in the home a few weeks after closing. We'll show you the options and the risks of each.

How long does it take to sell?

A well-priced home in Fort Worth, Aledo or Willow Park often goes under contract within a few weeks; acreage and unique properties can take longer because the buyer pool is smaller. From contract to closing is usually 30–45 days with financing, faster with cash.

Do I have to make repairs before listing?

No, but known issues either get fixed, priced for, or found by the buyer's inspector. We'll help you decide which is smartest for each item.

What does it cost to sell?

Commissions, title and closing costs, any repairs or credits, and sometimes a survey. We'll put the whole picture in your net sheet before you decide.

Want to know what your home is worth? Ask for a free home value and net sheet.

The Keefe Team · 817-807-3367 · lisa@lisakeefe.realtor · keefeteamrealty.com

Lisa Keefe, Broker Associate (TX #0691469) · Jennifer Keefe, REALTOR® (TX #0781916) · JLA Realty · Texas law requires license holders to provide the Information About Brokerage Services and Consumer Protection Notice: keefeteamrealty.com/iabs-consumer-protection-notice.pdf · This guide is general information, not legal, tax or financial advice.